Inglés técnico 2 DAW - Session 1:

Reading 1: General press article - Present simple vs present continuous.

How memes, gaming and internet culture all relate to the Charlie Kirk shooting

Kirk's rise to fame was largely **boosted** by being extremely **online** — and **it seems** the suspect **has** that in common.

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Hello, and welcome to TechScape. Dara Kerr here, **filling in** for Blake Montgomery, who **promises** he'll **come back from vacation**. Meanwhile, I'm looking at the **memes**, **gaming** and **internet** culture behind the shooting of Charlie Kirk.

The bullet that killed the conservative activist was inscribed with a message: "Notices Bulge OwO what's this?" The online world quickly recognized the reference. **It's** a phrase used in internet culture to **troll** people in online **role-play** communities, specifically furries (a subculture that **cosplays** as anthropomorphic animal characters).

"The phrase has been popularized not only as a way of making fun of furries and related communities for being **cringe**, but has also been **embraced** by furries as a way of owning the meme", **writes** Know Your Meme, a **website** that **documents** viral phenomena. "Ultimately, the phrase is **portrayed** in memes as being one of the most **cringeworthy** things someone could possibly write to another person."

Other bullets recovered by **law enforcement** in Utah also **have** inscriptions that **appear** to **nod** to online gaming and insider memes. One **says**: "O Bella Ciao, Bella Ciao". This message **refers** to an Italian anti-fascist folk song that has become a **gamer** reference that'**s** big in Twitch and Discord circles. The final bullet **says**: "Hey fascist, catch!", and is followed by an **up arrow, right arrow and three down arrows.** The arrow sequence **appears** to reference the videogame *Helldivers 2,* and **is** a **set of commands** used by **players** to **release** a bomb in the game. The **alleged** **shooter**, Tyler James Robinson, **is** a 22-year old from a small town in Utah near the Arizona **border**. He **is accused** of killing Kirk at a campus event at Utah Valley University in Orem, Utah. Kirk was killed by a single bullet fired with a rifle from a distant rooftop.

Charlie Kirk was 31. He was at the school on behalf of his conservative youth organization, Turning Point USA. He had become known **worldwide** debating others and speaking online about his extremist views on race, immigration, gender identity and gun rights on YouTube, Twitter (now X), TikTok and **live** events. A **key** figure in Donald Trump's success, college-aged conservatives followed him.

The decade or so between Kirk's beginnings as a teen activist and the shooting saw the rise of MAGA politics and the **shake-up** of the conventional **media** **landscape,** with Kirk playing a **crucial** role in both. Kirk founded Turning Point USA in 2012 with the goal of reaching young people, **similar** to how Obama did, but with a focus on **conservative** ideas. Even people who didn't agree with his views had to **admit** that he was everywhere in **politics**. For many young Americans, Kirk became **famous** for his use of **social media platforms and** for organizing live events.

Activities

A) **Before reading the text.**

1.- **Speaking part 1.**
a) Do you know Charlie Kirk? Explain who he was.
b) Explain the following term: MAGA.
c) What type of text is this? Identify the elements.

2.- **Listening**. Watch the video about Charlie Kirk.
https://youtube.com/shorts/XHEhZO44I-M?si=a51WSMFu0TgHAN-o

a) Describe what he used to do.
b) What do you think of him?
c) What's his message in this video and his relationship with the people attending his meetings?

B) After reading the text.

3.- **Reading** comprehension questions .

a) Are the following sentences **true or false** according to the article? **Correct** the false ones. You can find the evidence in the indicated paragraphs.

1.- Paragraph 1: Charlie Kirk was shot during his vacation.
2.- Paragraph 2: The bullet had a phrase connected to furry internet culture.
3.- Paragraph 2: The phrase "OwO what's this?" comes from gamer culture only.
4.- Paragraph 3: The phrase was only used to insult people, never embraced by furries themselves.
5.- Paragraph 3: Know your meme is a website about viral culture.

b) **Multiple choice questions:**

1.- Paragraph 3: "If you read this, you are gay, LMAO" is:
a) A romantic message.
b) A shocking internet joke.
c) A song lyric.
d) A famous speech.

2.- Paragraph 4: The phrase "O Bella Ciao" refers to:
a) A new video game.
b) An Italian anti-fascist song.
c) A message from Charlie Kirk.
d) A joke about gun rights.

2.- Paragraph 5: The arrow symbols on one casing come from:
a) TikTok trends.
b) Twitter memes.
c) A videogame.
d) YouTube comments.

c) **Short-answer questions:**

1.- How old is the shooter? Where is he from?
2.- Where did the shooting happen?
3.- What organization was Charlie Kirk representing at the university?
4.- What were some of Kirk's main political topics?
5.- How did Kirk become famous online? Mention at least two platforms.

4.- **Vocabulary**.

a) **General vocabulary.** Define, explain or provide a synonym of the words **in bold and underlined** in the context of the article.

b) **Specific vocabulary.** Define, explain or provide a synonym of the words in green. Foreign words in technology.

c) Strategies for learning vocabulary. Words in blue. Cognates.

5.- **Writing**. Make a **summary/abstract** of the **main ideas** of the article. Try to get one main idea per paragraph.

6.- **Speaking part 2.**

a) How is Internet culture connected to real-world violence in this article?

b) Can memes be dangerous? Why or why not?

c) The influence of social media in politics for young people.

d) Influencers. Do you follow any?

7.- **Grammar**. Personal pronouns. Present simple vs present continuous.